BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #50 · VISION AND HEARING LOSS

"I'm embarrassing to be around."

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Where it often comes from

Misheard answers, bumping into things, loud responses, and repeated requests can mortify us. We may fear that friends are ashamed to be seen with us.

What Scripture teaches

"Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart." "Love… does not boast, it is not proud… it keeps no account of wrongs" (1 Corinthians 13:4–5). True friends laugh with you, not at you, and stand by you. "A friend loves at all times" (Proverbs 17:17). God is not embarrassed by you: "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness."

> *"The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing"* (Zephaniah 3:17).

Also see

> "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'" (1 Samuel 16:7).

> "Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud. It is not rude, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no account of wrongs. Love takes no pleasure in evil, but rejoices in the truth. It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things" (1 Corinthians 13:4–7).

> "A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity" (Proverbs 17:17).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- They are ashamed of me.
- I make things awkward.
- People cringe when I talk.
- I embarrass my family.
- I should stay home.
- Nobody wants me in public.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either smooth or embarrassing.
- Fortune telling: Predicting shame.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling embarrassed and concluding that I embarrass others.
- Mind reading: Calling myself an embarrassment.

Challenging questions

- What have my friends actually said or done?
- Who stays close despite awkward moments?
- What would I do if my friend were in my place?
- How could humor and honesty help?
- What does God feel toward me?
- What is one outing I could try?

Truth summary

> God rejoices over me, and true friends do not leave over awkward moments. I can be honest about my loss, laugh when it helps, and keep showing up.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Friendship
- Pride
- Loneliness
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm embarrassing to be around"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm embarrassing to be around." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have my friends actually said or done?
- ☐ Who stays close despite awkward moments?
- ☐ What would I do if my friend were in my place?
- ☐ How could humor and honesty help?
- ☐ What does God feel toward me?
- ☐ What is one outing I could try?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord rejoices over me.
- ☐ He sees my heart.
- ☐ A friend loves at all times.
- ☐ Love keeps no record of wrongs.
- ☐ Awkward moments pass.
- ☐ I am not an embarrassment.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Zephaniah 3:17

  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7

  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 13:4–7

  "Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud. It is not rude, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no account of wrongs. Love takes no pleasure in evil, but rejoices in the truth. It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still showing up: Each week, note one outing or visit.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Zephaniah 3:17 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord rejoices over me with gladness.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Ask a friend. Check how they feel.
- [ ] Be honest. Mention your loss lightly at the start.
- [ ] Plan an easy outing. Choose a friendly place.
- [ ] Memorize Zephaniah 3:17. Say it before going out.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm embarrassing to be around": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still showing up
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm embarrassing to be around.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear embarrassing others. Remind me that You rejoice over me, and give me friends who stay. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.